

I found this an interesting paper, and appreciated (up to a point) the thoroughness with which the experimental results were analysed; however, I did have some concerns about the **theoretical underpinnings** of the work and the operationalisation involved.

I should note here that I have no specific expertise on any aspect of Hungarian and I have no prior theoretical commitment to any particular analysis of the phenomena in question; that is to say, I'm very willing to be persuaded of the correctness of the authors' analysis, but I have not been persuaded yet.

The essence of my concern is that, in summarising the results of this paper as a rebuttal of the strong semantic exhaustivity view, the authors argue (p.31) that that view yields three predictions that are not borne out by these data: "(i) non-exhaustive readings should be unavailable or highly marked, (ii) the unmodified PVF should be processed identically to the only-condition, and (iii) co-occurrence with *többek között* 'amongst others' should be degraded or induce a strong semantic conflict." The counterevidence for each point respectively is summarised as "Non-exhaustive readings were chosen in over a third of contrastive trials, the unmodified condition was processed more slowly than the explicitly marked exhaustive condition, and the contrastive condition was grammatically acceptable and produced meaningful, interpretable results."

My respective worries about these arguments are as follows:

(i) There's very little evidence here of participants spontaneously entertaining a non-exhaustive reading unless they are obliged to do so by the addition of 'amongst others', the explicit utterance of which could be argued to be a highly marked kind of occurrence.

(ii) This seems like an unmotivated claim, as far as the processing signature is concerned. I agree that the theory would predict that the same interpretation is ultimately arrived at, much like the case alluded to of 'only some' versus 'some' in scalar implicature-supporting contexts. But there doesn't seem to be any very convincing reason to posit identical processing pathways. To articulate one particular concern, the explicit presence of 'csak' might signal exhaustivity in some way that causes the reader to expect (or at least be less surprised by) the presence of pre-verbal focus, i.e. the fact that the next item is not a verb. If that were to happen - and I take it that this is pretty routine, as hearers routinely entertain rich probabilistic expectations about what will follow - there doesn't seem to be any reason to expect reading times and resulting gaze behaviour to be aligned between the PVF and 'only' conditions.

(iii) There doesn't seem to be any evidence in this paper that the co-occurrence with *többek között* isn't degraded and doesn't introduce a strong semantic conflict. I take it that it's the authors' judgment, as well as that of at least some prior work, that these sentences are essentially OK, but then this looks like a stronger argument against the semantic exhaustivity view than anything provided in this paper. **Unless I misunderstand the task here, arguing that the contrastive condition is acceptable because it produces 'meaningful, interpretable results' strikes me as very weak; participants are asked to choose which picture best matches what they've read, and an ability to do that doesn't seem like compelling evidence that what they've read is grammatical or coherent. (To labour the point, if I showed participants a red square and a blue square and said 'click on the red blue square', or indeed 'click on the red bluer square', I'd expect them to respond in some way, but that wouldn't evidence that the sentences were either grammatical or non-self-contradictory.)**

One thing that struck me in general, in terms of disentangling the competing theoretical analyses, is that **exhaustivity is usually taken to be relative to some restricted domain**; certainly if we consider an utterance like 'Anna ate only a banana', we don't interpret that in real life as an assertion that Anna

has never previously eaten anything except this one banana. So it wasn't wholly clear to me whether there was any real contradiction between the PVF having exhaustivity in its semantics and it being compatible with a continuation which acknowledges that, relative to a different domain, the claim arising from the PVF is not truly exhaustive. The question seems to be how the putatively semantic content is in fact supposed to relate to content which ostensibly contradicts it, and how we get from there to conclusions about whether that content is in fact semantic at all.

As a minor point, I did also wonder how participants are treating the pictorial representations in this study. As described here, participants are instructed to "select the image that best matched the meaning of the sentence they just read" (p.9). But as exemplified here, the pictures don't depict the sentence meanings, but rather some referents mentioned or otherwise potentially alluded to in the sentence. This is relevant because if you ask me to choose between pictures A and B in Figure 3 for the (obviously non-exhaustive) English sentence 'This morning Esther drank, among other things, coffee', there are clear arguments in favour of either picture: B because it depicts some other things besides coffee, A because it depicts coffee (which Esther certainly drank) and doesn't depict water and fruit juice (which Esther may have drunk, but may not; perhaps the 'other things' were in fact tea and champagne). Thus I wouldn't confidently interpret the choice of A as evidence of a persistent exhaustive interpretation of coffee.